

Frederik Weber Henriksen

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Research Profile

My research investigates how digital information environments — particularly alternative news media and anti-systemic counterpublics — reshape democratic opinion formation, polarization, and climate issues. I study these phenomena using digital methods, combining computational approaches (NLP, network analysis, automated classification) with surveys, data donations, and qualitative methods in mixed-methods designs.

Employment

2025–2028 Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Communication and Arts, Roskilde University

- Researcher on (1) the Carlsberg-funded AlterPublics project (Alternative media & ideological counterpublics) and (2) the Independent Research Fund Denmark-funded #Echopol project (Polarisation dynamics & digital echo chambers).
- Develop research designs combining digital trace data, computational text analysis (NLP), network analysis, survey data, data donations, and agent-based models.

2024 Research Assistant, Department of Communication and Arts, Roskilde University

- AlterPublics project: digital data collection and research design for the Nordic Alternative Media Observatory; contributed to manuscripts and conference dissemination.

2020–2021 Research Assistant, iCourts (ERC JustSites), Faculty of Law, University of Copenhagen

- Developed methodological framework and conducted quantitative analyses; built a large prosopographic dataset and coordinated student assistants and data specialists.

2020 Research Assistant, Department of Communication and Arts, Roskilde University

- VELUX-funded COVID-19/green transition project: survey design, recruitment, analysis, and reporting.

2019–2020 Teaching Assistant (30 hours/week), DTU

- Taught seminars and supported course delivery: Theory of Science for Engineers (ethics, SDGs, scientific knowledge production).

2019 Student Assistant (15 hours/week), City of Copenhagen

- Mixed-method evaluation: 30 interviews + web survey; authored municipal report on civic green initiatives.

2017–2019 Student Assistant (12 hours/week), Department of Learning and Philosophy, AAU

- Supported mixed-method research (MCA, surveys, interviews) and workshop organisation; team output includes peer-reviewed articles on body practices in the Danish healthcare field (see Publications).

Education

2024 PhD in Media and Communication Science, Roskilde University

- Article-based dissertation: "Burn it down — Anti-Systemic Narratives and Counterpublics in Digital Alternative Information Environments" (part of the Carlsberg-funded AlterPublics project).

2020 MA in Sociology (cand.scient.soc.), University of Copenhagen

- Specialisation in political sociology.

2017 BA in Sociology, University of Copenhagen

2015 BA in Philosophy, University of Copenhagen

2015 Exchange study, University of British Columbia

Research Stays

2023 Computational Communication Science Lab, University of Vienna

3 months; host: Prof. Annie Waldherr.

Teaching and Supervision

Course organisation and course teaching (selected)

- "News influencers in digital information environments" (elective) — 3–4 sessions, Autumn 2026.
- "Political Communication in a Hybrid Media System" (MA Media and Communication, 10 ECTS) — course organiser and lecturer (3 of 8 sessions), Fall 2024 and Fall 2025 (with J. B. Kristensen).
- "Scientific Methods in Journalism Research" (MA Journalism) — lectures on quantitative and automated content analysis, Fall 2024–25.
- "Digital Media: Strategy and Practices" (MA Communication) — research design and social analytics, Spring 2025 and Spring 2026.
- "Data and Things — Advanced Programming" (MA Computer Science) — large-scale network theory and AI, Spring 2026.
- "Responsible AI" (MA Computer Science) — AI and democracy, Fall 2025.
- "Journalism in war and crises" (MA Journalism) — disinformation and foreign interference, Fall 2022 and Fall 2025.
- "Journalistic Innovation" (MA Journalism) — supervision and examination of groups working with AI and news avoidance, Fall 2025.
- BA/MA lectures: "Journalism and Society" (BA Journalism, 2022), "Interaction, doxa, and networks" (MA Communication, 2022), "Sociology" (BA Social Sciences, 2021), "Trends in Digital Media and Communication Theory" (MA Communication, 2021).

Supervision and examination

- 10+ BA and 10+ MA project groups (PPL format) across the Journalism, Media and Communication, Social Sciences, and Humanities programmes at Roskilde University.
- MA thesis supervision (2 students, Spring 2025; thesis on media polarisation).

Workshops and pedagogical development

- Digital Media Lab workshop series: programming for total beginners (2023–26), social media data collection (Digital Methods Initiative tools), computational text analysis.
- Designed and taught the BA Humanities elective “Social Media and Digital Methods” (2022; 65 students, 8 sessions).
- AI-supported PPL supervision chatbot (CUTL certificate project; presented to deans and university leadership, January 2026), continued and scaled as RUCAI through Digi4Hum.

Earlier teaching

- Theory of Science for Engineers (DTU, 2019–2020): philosophy of knowledge, STS, ethics, UN Sustainable Development Goals.
- Sociological Theory and History of Ideas (UCPH, 2017); Open Workshop on practical learning (AAU, 2018).

Publications

Peer-reviewed journal articles

- 2026** Henriksen, F. M., Kristensen, J. B., & Mayerhöffer, E. **Climate obstruction in the digital far-right: Mapping the climate countermovement in German-, Danish-, and Swedish-speaking digital information environments.** *Environmental Communication*.
doi.org/10.1080/17524032.2026.2701866
- 2026** Henriksen, F. M., Mayerhöffer, E., & Kristensen, J. B. **Crisis as opportunity? Far-right mobilisation in digital information environments during the COVID-19 pandemic.** *New Media & Society*. doi.org/10.1177/14614448261443536
- 2026** Henriksen, F. M. **RUCAI: An open-source, local-first AI teaching assistant for course planning and classroom support.** *Computational Humanities Research (Cambridge University Press)*.
doi.org/10.1017/chr.2026.10038
- 2025** Grahn, H., Kalsnes, B., Isaksson, E., Mayerhöffer, E., Ólafsson, J. G., Falkheimer, J., Henriksen, F. M., Kristensen, J. B., & Saari, D. **Mapping research on disinformation and misinformation across the Nordic countries: An integrative review.** *Nordicom Review*, 46(S1).
doi.org/10.2478/nor-2025-0015
- 2024** Henriksen, F. M., Kristensen, J. B., & Mayerhöffer, E. **Dissemination of RT and Sputnik content in European digital alternative news environments: Mapping the influence of Russian state-backed media across platforms, topics, and ideology.** *International Journal of Press/Politics*, 29(3), 795–818. doi.org/10.1177/19401612241230281
- 2024** Henriksen, F. M. **Anti-systemic counterpublics: Rethinking the counterpublic sphere.** *Javnost — The Public*, 31(2), 213–230. doi.org/10.1080/13183222.2024.2342219
- 2023** Kristensen, J. B., Henriksen, F. M., & Mayerhöffer, E. **Did COVID-19 blur partisan boundaries? A comparison of partisan affinity and source heterophily in online alternative news-sharing networks before and during the pandemic.** *Social Media + Society*, 9(3).
doi.org/10.1177/20563051231192963
- 2022** Larsen, K., Hindhede, A. L., Larsen, M. H., Nicolaisen, M. H., & Henriksen, F. M. **Bodies need yoga? No plastic surgery! Naturalistic versus instrumental bodies among professions in the Danish healthcare field.** *Social Theory & Health*, 20(1). doi.org/10.1057/s41285-020-00151-z

2020 Larsen, K., Larsen, M. H., Henriksen, F. M., Nicolaisen, M. H., & Hindhede, A. L. **Investing in surgery or yoga among professions?: Distinctions in health investments in the Danish healthcare field.** *Social Science & Medicine*, 1–25.

2020 Larsen, K., Hindhede, A. L., & Henriksen, F. M. **Sundhedskapital blandt danske sundhedsprofessionelle: En kvantitativ og kvalitativ undersøgelse af kropsopfattelser og distinktion blandt forskere, klinikere og studerende i Danmark.** *Praktiske Grunde: Nordisk tidsskrift for kultur- og samfundsvidenskab*.

Book chapter (in press)

2026 Henriksen, F. M. **Mapping the margins: Building a cross-national observatory for alternative news media research.** In E. Mayerhöffer et al. (Eds.), *Alternative Media in European Contexts*. Palgrave Macmillan.

Under review

Henriksen, F. M. **Do generative large language models close the language gap in multilingual discourse classification?** *Computational Communication Research*.

Mayerhöffer, E., Pedersen, L., & Henriksen, F. M. **Alternative news use beyond (dis)trust: Linking alternative news orientation to citizens' struggles for recognition.** *Information, Communication & Society*.

Kakavand, A., Henriksen, F. M., Stecker, M., & Kathirgamalingam, A. **An evaluation of computational user identity linkage approaches: Matching far-right actors across social media platforms.** *Communication Methods and Measures*.

Sivertsen, M. F., & Henriksen, F. M. **Do tech professionals align with democratic norms?** *European Sociological Review*.

Doctoral dissertation

2024 Henriksen, F. M. **Burn it down: Anti-Systemic Narratives and Counterpublics in Digital Alternative Information Environments.** *Doctoral dissertation, Roskilde University*.

Data and web publications

2026 Henriksen, F. M., Mayerhöffer, E., & Kristensen, J. B. **Climate obstruction in the digital far-right: dataset.** *figshare*. doi.org/10.6084/m9.figshare.33054782

2024 Henriksen, F. M. **Anti-systemic populism during the Covid-19 pandemic.** *Web publication, Roskilde University*.

2024 Mayerhöffer, E., Henriksen, F. M., & Kristensen, J. B. **Digitale modoffentligheder på sociale medier.** *Web publication, Roskilde University*.

2022 Ramsland, T., Henriksen, F. M., Kristensen, J. B., & Mayerhöffer, E. **Spredning af RT & Sputnik i alternative nyhedsmiljøer: Hvordan dansk-, svensk- og tysksprogede alternative nyhedsmiljøer deler indhold fra russiske statsmedier.** *Zenodo*. doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.7125103

Press (Danish)

2026 Messerschmidts comeback-maskine. *Politiken* (March 2026).

2026 Mona Juul er »stiktosset«: Billedfejl i Epstein-dækning kan forfølge hende. *Politiken* (February 2026).

2025 Michael Bang Petersen ser et behov for kaos. Jeg ser også et lukket system. Politiken (December 2025).

2024 Facebookgrupper er blevet dørmænd for den offentlige debat. Op-ed, Politiken (October 2024, with E. Mayerhöffer and J. B. Kristensen).

2022 Censurerede russiske medier skulle skabe splid i Vesten, viser dansk undersøgelse. Press release, multiple outlets (October 2022, with E. Mayerhöffer, T. Ramsland, J. B. Kristensen).

Funding and Proposal Work

2026 IKH Early Career Grant (50,000 DKK; applied). Pilot project: data donation platform for AI-mediated communication research.

2024 DFF proposal (co-authored): Understanding party organisational routines and knowledge utilisation in parliament. *PI Jesper Dahl Kelstrup; WP1 computational design, data strategy, and methods writing.*

Academic Service

2023–2024 Board member, PhD Committee, Department of Communication and Arts, Roskilde University.

2023 Member of working group on organisational policies, Roskilde University.

Peer reviewer: Information, Communication & Society; Media, War & Conflict; New Media and Society; Policy & Internet; Popular Communication.

Memberships and Affiliations

- Digital Media Lab, Department of Communication and Arts, RUC (member since 2021; acting head of tech, 2024)
- Research group: Digital Publics and Trust, DCA, RUC
- Research group: Journalism and Democracy, DCA, RUC
- Centre for Digital Citizenship, RUC
- EU Knowledge Hub on Prevention of Radicalisation (appointed academic expert, 2025)
- Digi4Hum team, RUC (appointed 2026, technical support)

Awards and Scholarships

2025 Teaching Prize, Digital Media Lab, Roskilde University (team award; DKK 25,000).

2014 Knud Højgaards Fond (university exchange stipend).

2014 Oticon Fond (university exchange stipend).

External Engagement and Invited Presentations

2026 Keynote speaker (invited), Northern Star Symposium, Bodø.

2025 Workshop on digital methods, University of Southern Denmark.

2025 Presentation at Center for Tracking and Society, University of Copenhagen.

2025 Seminar on online extremism, counterpublics, and conspiracy theories, University of Copenhagen.

2024 Russian disinformation before and during the European election 2024, Moderaterne.

2023 Making use of AI and large language models, Norion Consult.

2023 Computational Communication Science Lab, University of Vienna.

Conference Presentations (selected)

2026 ICA (76th), Cape Town | ADD Academic Conference: Controversies of AI Society

2025 Nordmedia, Odense | AOIR, Rio de Janeiro | Simulated Societies, Siena | COMPTXT (7th), Vienna

2024 ECREA (11th), Ljubljana | Democracy & Digital Citizenship (2nd), Odense | ECPR General Conference, Dublin | ICA (74th), Gold Coast | Political Ecologies of the Far Right (2nd), Uppsala

2023 ICA (73rd), Toronto | Technology in Movement, Copenhagen | Researching the Far-Right, Vienna

2022 ECREA (9th), Aarhus | IJPP Conference (8th), Loughborough | ICA (72nd), Paris | Democracy & Digital Citizenship (1st), Roskilde | Media and Publics (1st), Roskilde (presenter and session chair)

Media Appearances and Public Engagement

2024 Det Politiske Mødested: Er Europa rustet til at modstå Putins troldehær. *Panel (April 2024).*

2022 Forsker: Ingen stærke tegn på russisk indblanding i valgkamp. *Interview, Ritzau/Berlingske (October 2022).*

Skills and Languages

Languages: Danish (native), English (fluent).

Computational: Python, R, PostgreSQL; Hugging Face (Transformers).

Methods: NLP / text-as-data, network analysis, surveys, agent-based modelling; mixed methods.

Tools: Gephi, NetLogo, 4CAT; UCloud; Office; AI tools.

References

Eva Mayerhöffer (Associate Professor), Roskilde University evamay@ruc.dk

Jannie Møller Hartley (Full Professor), Roskilde University jath@ruc.dk

Annie Waldherr (Full Professor), University of Vienna annie.waldherr@univie.ac.at

Mikkel Jarle Christensen (Professor WSR), University of Copenhagen
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